habit of industry into our bridewells, and restraining the shocking debauchery and immorality which prevail in our gaols and other prisons—if any of these beneficial consequences shall accrue, the writer will be happy in the pleasing reflection that he has not lived without doing some good to his fellow-creatures; and will think himself abundantly repaid for all the pains he has taken, the time he has spent, and the hazards he has encountered.

CONCLUSION

To The Account of Lazarettos

"In my late inquiries into the state of the prisons of this country, it has given me sincere pleasure to find, that, from the attention of the magistrates, and the operation of the salutary Act for preserving the health of prisoners, the gaols of the capital, though crowded, have been freed from that disease which formerly destroyed more persons than the hand of the executioner; and those in the country have been so much improved, that most of them may now be visited without hazard of infection; whilst the judges are secured from those risks which formerly attended them in the discharge of their important office. With satisfaction I have also observed the liberal and humane spirit which engages the public to alleviate the sufferings of prisoners in general, and particularly, to release many industrious, though unfortunate, debtors. But at this point, the spirit of improvement unhappily seems to stop, scarcely touching upon that still more important object, the reformation of morals in our prisons: yet it is obvious that if this be neglected, besides the evil consequences that must result from such a source of wickedness, a suspicion will arise, that what has been already done has proceeded, chiefly, from the selfish motive of avoiding the danger to our own health, in attending courts of judicature.

"In this further reformation, it will be absolutely necessary to begin with the capital: for as, in my former visits, when I have met with the gaol-fever in county prisons, I have been almost constantly told, that it was derived from those in London; so the corruption of manners also, flowing from that great fountain, spreads far and wide its malignant streams. In what prison in London is there a proper separation of criminals, the

old from the young, convicts from the untried? Where are the night-rooms for solitary confinement and reflection? Where is any proper attention paid to sick and dying prisoners? Where are the rules and orders of magistrates for the direction of gaolers, and the government of prisoners? In what gaol are not the ears shocked with the profaneness both of prisoners and turnkeys? Where is any regard paid to the Lord's day? Where is not the afternoon of that day a time of greater concourse of visitants than any other? And, though the gaoler's taps are abolished, yet, are not publicans continually waiting to serve the prisoners, and their company? Is not beer now sold by the debtors? And do not turnkeys keep shops in the gaols?

"No effectual reform will be made in our prisons till the root of these evils be cut off, which, from the closest observation, I am convinced is the vice of drunkenness. To this end, restraints must be laid, which will, to many, I am sensible, appear harsh and severe; but, in this matter, there is no medium: any indulgence to particular classes of prisoners will ruin the whole design. It will, in my idea, be absolutely necessary to prohibit the introduction of any kind of liquor except milk, whey, butter-milk, or water into gaols; and in order to diminish the apparent hardship upon debtors, I heartily wish that such an alteration were made in our laws with respect to confinement for debt, that none should undergo it but dishonest and fraudulent debtors. Such are criminals, and ought to be treated accordingly.

"With regard to the health and real comfort of prisoners, I am persuaded, they would be promoted by such a prohibition. Within fourteen years, how many prisoners, together with their keepers, have I known destroyed by drinking, and how many convicts, going out of the world, in a state of intoxication! Criminals are, for the most part, under the middle age of life, and therefore strong enough in constitution to bear the trial of thoroughly breaking their bad habits; and as to debtors,[1] who generally live in prisons in utter idleness, they can have little occasion for strong liquors, and would receive much more benefit from a little addition of meat and vegetables to their diet, which, by this restriction, they might better afford.[2]

[1] "Of this class how many persons have I known, or heard of, who have gone into prison sober men; but who have either destroyed themselves there by drinking, or have gone out mere sots?

[2] "If Gentlemen of the Faculty, and others, still object to the exclusion of all fermented liquors from gaols, under the idea that their use is in some measure necessary as antiseptics, I would desire them to consider that by